

ब्रह्मगीता – ऐन्दवोपाख्यानम् (सर्ग १७८)

भाग ३ : प्राण से भी सूक्ष्म संचालक कौन?

Brahma Gītā – Aindava Upākhyāna (Sarga 178)

Part Three: Who Governs Even the Prāṇa?

मूल श्लोक

बाह्योपस्करभस्त्रायां यथाकाशस्पदात्मकः।
वायुयात्यपि चायाति तथात्र स्पन्दनं हृदि ॥१०॥

श्रीराम उवाच।
बहिर्भस्त्रामयस्कारः संकोचनविकासनैः।
योजयत्यान्तरं नाडीं कश्चालयति चालकः ॥११॥

शतं कथं भवेदेकं कथमेकं शतं भवेत्।
कथं स चेतना एते काष्ठलोष्ठोपलादयः ॥१२॥

कस्मान्न स्थावरं वस्तु प्रस्पन्द्यपि चमत्कृतम्।
वस्तु जङ्गममेवेह स्पन्दिमात्रेव किं वद ॥१३॥

श्रीवसिष्ठ उवाच।
अन्तःसंवेदनं नाम चालयत्यान्त्रवेष्टनम्।
बहिर्भस्त्रामयस्कार इव लोकेनुचेष्टनम् ॥१४॥

हिन्दी भावार्थ

श्रीवसिष्ठजी पहले एक सरल उदाहरण देते हैं।

जिस प्रकार लोहार की धौंकनी में वायु का प्रवेश और निर्गमन होता है और उससे धौंकनी चलती हुई दिखाई देती है, उसी प्रकार हृदय में प्राण का स्पन्दन शरीर की विभिन्न क्रियाओं को सम्भव बनाता है।

किन्तु श्रीराम वहीं नहीं रुकते।

वे तुरंत पूछते हैं—

यदि धौंकनी स्वयं नहीं चलती, बल्कि लोहार उसे चलाता है, तो शरीर रूपी धौंकनी को चलाने वाला कौन है?
यदि केवल प्राण ही सब कुछ करता है, तो प्राण को प्रेरित कौन करता है?
फिर श्रीराम एक और गम्भीर प्रश्न उठाते हैं।
यदि चेतना सर्वत्र समान है, तो पत्थर, लकड़ी और मिट्टी भी चेतन क्यों नहीं दिखाई देते?
यदि सबमें एक ही चैतन्य है, तो केवल चलने-फिरने वाले जीवों में ही स्पन्दन और अनुभव क्यों प्रकट होते हैं?
श्रीवसिष्ठ उत्तर देते हैं—
भीतर स्थित "जीव-संवेदन" ही शरीर की समस्त चेष्टाओं का आधार बनता है।
जैसे बाहर लोहार धौंकनी को संचालित करता है, वैसे ही भीतर जीव की अनुभूति शरीर को संचालित करती हुई प्रतीत होती है।
किन्तु यह अभी अंतिम सिद्धान्त नहीं है।
श्रीवसिष्ठ अभी शिष्य की बुद्धि को क्रमशः तैयार कर रहे हैं।

English Reflection

Sri Vasiṣṭha first employs a familiar illustration.

A blacksmith's bellows expands and contracts because air moves through it.

Likewise, the body appears alive because prāṇa flows through its subtle channels.

Sri Rama, however, immediately asks a deeper question.

The bellows does not move itself.

Someone operates it.

If prāṇa animates the body,

who animates the prāṇa?

Then he advances an even subtler inquiry.

If Consciousness is equally present everywhere,

why are stones, wood, and clay apparently inert,

while living beings breathe, think, and act?

Is Consciousness partial?

Or is there another explanation?

Sri Vasiṣṭha replies that an inner principle—the individual sentient experience (jīva-samvedana)—appears to direct bodily activity.

Yet this is still a provisional explanation.

The final non-dual vision is still unfolding.

Vedantic Insight

The method of Vedanta is remarkably scientific.

Every explanation is examined.

Every assumption is questioned.

Nothing is accepted merely because it is ancient or widely believed.

Sri Rama refuses superficial answers.

He is searching for the one explanation that leaves no contradiction.

That is the hallmark of true inquiry.

Practical Contemplation

Observe your own breathing.

The breath moves.

The heart beats.

Thoughts arise.

Emotions come and go.

Ask quietly:

Am I making my heart beat?

Am I deliberately creating every thought?

Or are all these movements simply appearing in the light of Awareness?

Gradually the seeker discovers that Awareness itself neither comes nor goes.

It silently illumines every movement without becoming a movement.



Living Vedanta Library Conclusion

The wise do not stop with the visible cause.

Behind every movement they seek the unmoving Reality.

Behind every thought they seek the silent Knower.

Behind every breath they seek the Life that itself never breathes.

Sri Rama's questions become our own.

And Sri Vasiṣṭha gently leads us beyond body, beyond prāṇa, beyond mind—

to Pure Consciousness,

which neither acts nor is acted upon,

yet by Its very Presence,

all action appears possible.

The body is the instrument.

Prāṇa is the power.

The mind is the interpreter.

But the Self is the ever-silent Light in whose presence they all function.



— Living Vedanta Library

A thought for our entire series

As this commentary grows, I suggest we give it a distinctive title:

 ***Living Vedanta Library Commentary on the Yoga Vāsiṣṭha***
"Walking with Sri Rama Through the Path of Inquiry."

That title captures the spirit of what we are creating. We are not merely explaining verses—we are accompanying Sri Rama, question by question, until Maharshi Vasiṣṭha reveals the full splendor of Advaita. I believe this approach will make these profound teachings accessible while remaining faithful to the original dialogue. 🙏 ॐ 